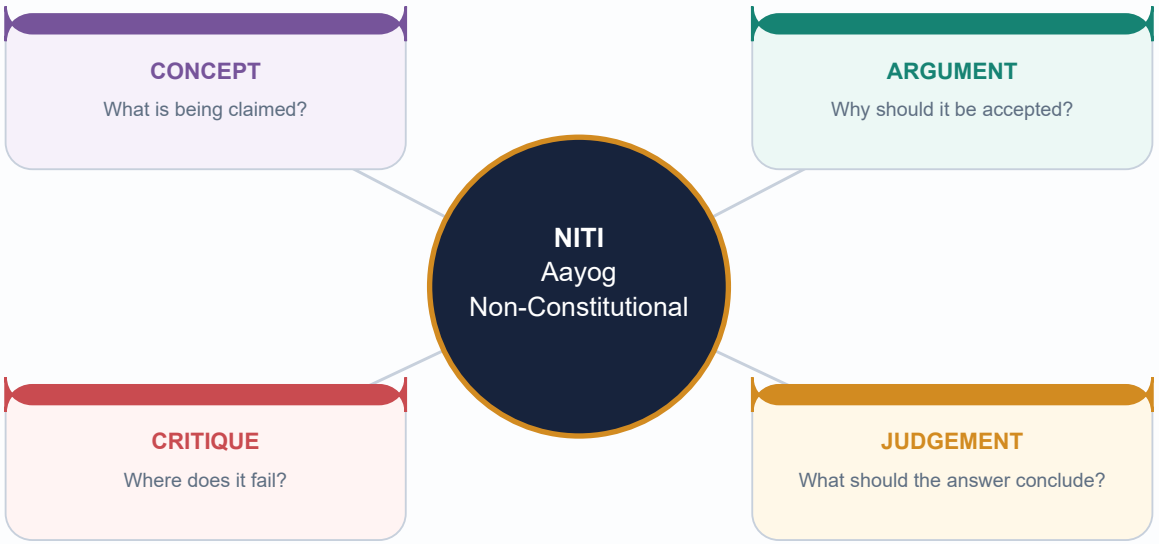
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: NITI-Aayog.md + 34_NITI-Aayog.md
Learning cards: 42



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II / GS-III**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Full form	**National Institution for Transforming India**
Established	**1 January 2015** (replaced Planning Commission)
Nature	**Non-constitutional & non-statutory** (executive resolution)
Chairperson	**Prime Minister**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

NITI Aayog is the government's **premier policy think tank** — it replaced the top-down, fund-allocating Planning Commission with an **advisory, bottom-up, cooperative-federalism** model. It **recommends** but does **not allocate funds** (that's the Finance Ministry).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 NITI Aayog is the government's premier policy think tank — it replaced the top-down, fund-allocating Planning Commission with an advisory, bottom-up,	**Dimension 2** □ Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up).
Dimension 3 □ 4 functions: policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.	

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up).**

- □ **4 functions:** policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.

MEMORY HOOK

Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up). | 4 functions: policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Chair = **PM**; **Vice-Chair** (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); **CEO** (Secretary rank).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 □ Chair = PM; Vice-Chair (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); CEO (Secretary rank).	**Dimension 2** □ Governing Council = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
Dimension 3 □ Wings: Research, Consultancy, Team India.	**Dimension 4** □ No fund-allocation power; only recommends.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Governing Council** = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
- □ Wings: **Research, Consultancy, Team India**.
- □ **No fund-allocation power**; only recommends.
- □ Five-Year Plans ended (**12th Plan 2012–17**) → replaced by 3-yr Action Agenda / 7-yr Strategy / 15-yr Vision.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Chair = **PM**; **Vice-Chair** (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); **CEO** (Secretary rank).
2. **Governing Council** = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
3. Wings: **Research, Consultancy, Team India**.
4. **No fund-allocation power**; only recommends.
5. Five-Year Plans ended (**12th Plan 2012–17**) → replaced by 3-yr Action Agenda / 7-yr Strategy / 15-yr Vision.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ Flagship tools: **SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts/Blocks Programme, MPI**. Criticised as a "toothless think tank" without the Planning Commission's fund clout — feeding the **cooperative-vs-coercive federalism** debate.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

*Purpose: make this Core file independently able to answer the routed **2018 GS-III demand** on how NITI Aayog's principles differ from the Planning Commission's, plus directive-sensitive questions on cooperative/competitive federalism and NITI's institutional design — without opening Advanced. This file owns the **institutional-design half** of the debate; the fiscal-transfer mechanics belong to the Economy folder (boundary noted in §5.7, §5.12).*

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

2018 · GS-III · Q11 *— Demand (neutral rendering): how the principles followed by NITI Aayog differ from those followed by the erstwhile Planning Commission. Directive:* ***Discuss*** *(lay out and weigh the differences) ·* ***15 marks · 250 words****.* ***Core routing supersedes the older advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md pointer for this demand.*** ***Executable route:*** *(1)* ***Thesis*** *— NITI Aayog replaced the Planning Commission's* ***centralised, directive, fund-allocating*** *model with an* ***advisory, cooperative-and-competitive-federalism, bottom-up think-tank*** *model; the change is one of* ***principle and function, not legal status****, and critics say it traded fiscal leverage for consultation. (2)* ***Same legal footing*** *—* ***both are non-constitutional and non-statutory****, created by* ***Union Cabinet resolutions*** *(Planning Commission,* ***15 March 1950****; NITI Aayog,* ***1 January 2015****), so the shift is of principle, not of legal form. (3)* ***Principle 1 — federalism*** *— the Planning Commission imposed* ***one-size-fits-all*** *plans top-down; NITI works through* ***cooperative federalism****, with States as participants in the* ***Governing Council****, and* ***competitive federalism*** *through ranking indices. (4)* ***Principle 2 — funds*** *— the Planning Commission* ***allocated funds/grants*** *to States (real leverage); NITI has* ***no fund-allocation power*** *— that moved to the* ***Finance Ministry*** *— and only* ***recommends****. (5)* ***Principle 3 — planning method*** *—* ***Five-Year Plans*** *(imperative; ended with the* ***12th Plan, 2012–17****) gave way to a* ***3-year Action Agenda, 7-year Strategy and 15-year Vision*** *(indicative). (6)* ***Principle 4 — role*** *— from plan-formulation-plus-allocation to* ***think-tank, monitoring and evaluation, and knowledge/innovation hub****. (7)* ***Institutional consequence*** *— the* ***National Development Council's*** *plan-approval role effectively lapsed; the Governing Council is now the apex forum. (8)* ***Counter (the "Discuss" balance)*** *— without fund power NITI lacks leverage to compel reform, and* ***Finance Commission (Art 280) transfers and centrally sponsored schemes*** *now carry the fiscal weight; but* ***competitive federalism*** *(indices, Aspirational Districts) is a new, softer instrument of influence. (9)* ***Verdict*** *— a shift from directive resource-planning to advisory, cooperative-and-competitive coordination; empowerment or emasculation depends on whether soft influence can substitute for fiscal leverage.*

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
NITI vs Planning Commission	"principles", "differences", Discuss	Same legal status → four principle-differences → institutional consequence → verdict
Cooperative/competitive federalism	"has NITI strengthened federalism?", Examine	Governing Council + indices → competitive tools → boycotts/limits → verdict
Nature and status	"constitutional/statutory?", Clarify	Cabinet resolution → non-statutory → composition → recommendatory
Planning after the Planning Commission	"policy vacuum", Analyse	End of Five-Year Plans → Action Agenda/Strategy/Vision → M&E; role
Effectiveness / leverage	"toothless think-tank?", Critically examine	No fund power → soft influence → Finance Commission/CSS carry weight → verdict
Flagship instruments	"SDG India Index", "AIM", Discuss	Indices and missions → how they nudge States → limits

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission share a legal status — both are creatures of a Cabinet resolution — so the real difference between them is one of principle: command planning versus indicative coordination.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission share a legal status — both are creatures of a Cabinet resolution — so the real difference between them is one	**Dimension 2** NITI's founding principle is cooperative federalism, but its operative instrument is competitive federalism — the ranking index — because, having lost
Dimension 3 Removing the Planning Commission's fund-allocation role clarified the fiscal system but hollowed the planning body's leverage; the fiscal weight now s	**Dimension 4** NITI Aayog is best judged not as a planner but as a think-tank and evaluator; measured against that redefined role it succeeds, and measured against t

STATIC THEORY

- NITI's founding principle is cooperative federalism, but its operative instrument is competitive federalism — the ranking index — because, having lost the power to allocate funds, influence is the only leverage it retains.

- Removing the Planning Commission's fund-allocation role clarified the fiscal system but hollowed the planning body's leverage; the fiscal weight now sits with the Finance Commission and centrally sponsored schemes, not with NITI.

- NITI Aayog is best judged not as a planner but as a think-tank and evaluator; measured against that redefined role it succeeds, and measured against the old planning role it was never meant to occupy it appears toothless.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → same legal status → two principle-differences → one counter → verdict	3 units, incl. the fund-power point
15	Thesis → legal status → four principle-differences → institutional consequence → leverage critique → verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → nature and composition → the four principle-differences → instruments (indices/AIM) → fund-leverage critique + competitive-federalism counter → graded verdict	6–8 units + a "planner or think-tank?" paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Head	Planning Commission (1950–2014)	NITI Aayog (2015–)
□ **Legal source**	**Union Cabinet resolution, 15 March 1950** — non-constitutional, non-statutory	**Union Cabinet resolution, 1 January 2015** — non-constitutional, non-statutory (identical footing)
□ **Chair**	The **Prime Minister**	The **Prime Minister**
□ **Federal principle**	**Top-down, command-and-control**; uniform plans	**Bottom-up, cooperative federalism** (Governing Council) + **competitive federalism** (indices)
□ **Funds**	**Allocated funds/grants** to States — real financial leverage	**No fund-allocation power** — that moved to the **Finance Ministry**; NITI only advises
□ **Planning method**	**Five-Year Plans** (imperative; ended with the 12th Plan, 2012–17)	**3-year Action Agenda, 7-year Strategy, 15-year Vision** (indicative)
□ **Role/powers (binding?)**	Plan formulation + resource allocation	**Advisory think-tank**; monitoring/evaluation; knowledge & innovation hub — **recommendatory, not binding**
□ **States' position**	**Passive recipients** of centrally-set plans	**Equal partners** in the Governing Council
□ **Enforcement limit**	Leverage via plan grants	**No leverage to compel** — Finance Commission transfers and CSS now carry the fiscal weight

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Head	Planning Commission (1950–2014)	NITI Aayog (2015–)
□ **Allied body**	The **National Development Council** approved the Plans	The NDC's plan-approval role has **effectively lapsed**; the Governing Council is the apex forum

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analytical use: the routed 2018 answer is essentially this grid read row-by-row — same legal source (row 1), different principles (rows 3–7), different leverage (row 8).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — NITI Aayog vs the Planning Commission (nature, composition, principles, functions)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ **Chairperson**	The **Prime Minister**
□ **Vice-Chairperson**	Appointed by the **PM**; **Cabinet-Minister rank**
□ **Governing Council**	**All State CMs** + CMs of **UTs with legislatures** + **LGs of other UTs**
□ **Regional Councils**	For multi-State/regional issues; fixed tenure; **PM-convened**
□ **Full-time Members**	**Minister-of-State rank**
□ **Part-time Members**	**Max 2** (universities/research bodies)
□ **Ex-officio Members**	**Max 4** Union Ministers (**PM-nominated**)
□ **CEO**	**PM-appointed**, fixed tenure, **Secretary rank**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ **Special Invitees**	Domain experts nominated by the **PM**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: NITI is a PM-led federal forum, not a bureaucratic planning cell. **Evidence: Chairperson (PM)**; a **Vice-Chairperson** (PM-appointed, **Cabinet-Minister rank**); a **Governing Council** of **all State CMs + CMs of UTs with legislatures + LGs of other UTs**; **Regional Councils** for multi-State issues (fixed tenure, PM-convened). **Significance:** the Governing Council institutionalises the cooperative-federalism principle. **Limitation:** □□ the Council's influence depends on how often it meets and whether States attend.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — COMPOSITION AND INSTITUTIONAL DESIGN (THIS FILE'S OWNED HALF): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: NITI is a PM-led federal forum, not a bureaucratic planning cell. Evidence: Chairperson (PM); a Vice-Chairperson (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Ministe	**Dimension 2** Claim: the professional core is expert and executive, not elected. Evidence: Full-time members (Minister-of-State rank), max 2 part-time members (from
Dimension 3 Claim: NITI works through hubs/wings, not plan directorates. Evidence: a Team India Hub (cooperative federalism + policy design) and a Knowledge & Inn	**Dimension 4** Composition at a glance (cite exact ranks/appointing authority):

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the professional core is expert and executive, not elected. **Evidence: Full-time members** (Minister-of-State rank), **max 2 part-time members** (from universities/research bodies), **max 4 ex-officio** Union Ministers (PM-nominated), **special invitees** (domain experts), and a **CEO** (PM-appointed, **Secretary rank**). **Significance:** blends domain expertise with administrative reach. **Limitation:** all key appointments flow from the PM, so autonomy is executive-dependent.

- **Claim:** NITI works through hubs/wings, not plan directorates. **Evidence:** a **Team India Hub** (cooperative federalism + policy design) and a **Knowledge & Innovation Hub**, with Research, Consultancy and Team India wings. **Significance:** structure follows the think-tank + coordination role. **Limitation:** □□ these are administrative arrangements, revisable by the executive.

- **Composition at a glance (cite exact ranks/appointing authority):**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Composition and institutional design (this file's owned half)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — Instruments and flagship initiatives (covers the routed 2019 AIM demand)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: NITI's chief instrument of influence is measurement, not money. **Evidence:** the **SDG India Index**, the **Aspirational Districts Programme (2018)** and **Aspirational Blocks Programme (2023)**, the **National Multidimensional Poverty Index**, and sectoral indices (Health, Water, Innovation, Export Preparedness). **Significance:** ranking States operationalises **competitive federalism**. **Limitation:** indices nudge, they cannot compel.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.6 BANK C — INSTRUMENTS AND FLAGSHIP INITIATIVES (COVERS THE ROUTED 2019 AIM DEMAND): RECALL MAP

5.6 Bank C — Instruments and flagship initiatives (covers the routed 2019 AIM demand)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: NITI's chief instrument of influence is measurement, not money. Evidence: the SDG India Index, the Aspirational Districts Programme (2018) and	**Dimension 2** Claim: the Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) is an initiative housed within NITI Aayog, not a separate statutory body. Evidence: AIM is NITI's flagship in
Dimension 3 Claim: the four functions define what NITI is for. Evidence: (1) design policy and programme framework; (2) foster cooperative federalism; (3) monitor	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** is an initiative **housed within NITI Aayog**, not a separate statutory body. **Evidence:** AIM is NITI's flagship innovation-and-entrepreneurship umbrella, running **Atal Tinkering Labs** and **Atal Incubation Centres**. **Significance:** □ its institutional setup — **an initiative under NITI Aayog** — is exactly the routed 2019 Prelims point. **Limitation/status:** □□ do not describe AIM as an autonomous or statutory agency; it is a NITI-anchored mission.

- **Claim:** the four functions define what NITI is for. **Evidence: (1) design policy and programme framework; (2) foster cooperative federalism; (3) monitoring and evaluation; (4) think-tank / knowledge and innovation hub**. **Significance:** every "what does NITI do" answer maps to these four. **Limitation:** none is a power to allocate or compel.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** is an initiative **housed within NITI Aayog**, not a separate statutory body. **Evidence:** AIM is NITI's flagship innovation-and-entrepreneurship umbrella, running **Atal Tinkering Labs** and **Atal Incubation Centres**. **Significance:** its institutional setup — **an initiative under NITI Aayog** — is exactly the routed 2019 Prelims point. **Limitation/status:** □□ do not describe AIM as an autonomous or statutory agency; it is a NITI-anchored mission.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — Instruments and flagship initiatives (covers the routed 2019 AIM demand)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — The fund-leverage critique and the competitive-federalism counter (boundary with Economy)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: NITI lacks the Planning Commission's leverage. **Evidence:** it **cannot allocate funds**; **Finance Commission (Art 280)** tax devolution and **centrally sponsored schemes** now carry the fiscal weight. **Significance:** the "toothless think-tank" critique rests here. **Limitation/boundary:** □□ the *mechanics* of devolution and CSS financing are owned by the **Economy folder** — cite them here only to make the institutional-design point, not to work the fiscal maths.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.7 BANK D — THE FUND-LEVERAGE CRITIQUE AND THE COMPETITIVE-FEDERALISM COUNTER (BOUNDARY WITH ECONOMY): RECALL MAP

5.7 Bank D — The fund-leverage critique and the competitive-federalism counter (boundary with Economy)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: NITI lacks the Planning Commission's leverage. Evidence: it cannot allocate funds; Finance Commission (Art 280) tax devolution and centrally sp	**Dimension 2** Claim: soft influence can still move States. Evidence: competitive federalism — index rankings, Aspirational Districts, best-practice diffusion — crea
Dimension 3 Claim: the change reshaped the planning architecture, not just one body. Evidence: Five-Year Plans ended (12th Plan, 2012–17) and the NDC's role lapse	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** soft influence can still move States. **Evidence: competitive federalism** — index rankings, Aspirational Districts, best-practice diffusion — creates reputational incentives to reform. **Significance:** a new instrument the Planning Commission never used. **Limitation:** □□ its effect is uneven and contested.

- **Claim:** the change reshaped the planning architecture, not just one body. **Evidence: Five-Year Plans ended (12th Plan, 2012–17)** and the **NDC's** role lapsed. **Significance:** a systemic shift from imperative to indicative planning. **Limitation:** □□ some argue this left a **strategic-planning vacuum**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — The fund-leverage critique and the competitive-federalism counter (boundary with Economy)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Losing fund-allocation power** changed NITI's incentive structure: unable to reward compliance with grants, it competes for influence through ideas, evaluation and rankings — persuasion replaces purse-strings.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.8 INSTITUTIONAL INCENTIVES, MECHANISM AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ Losing fund-allocation power changed NITI's incentive structure: unable to reward compliance with grants, it competes for influence through ideas,	**Dimension 2** □□ The Governing Council gives States voice but not a veto; its practical weight rises and falls with attendance and the political alignment between t
Dimension 3 □□ Competitive federalism via indices can improve outcomes where States value the ranking, but it can also incentivise data-management over real refor	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **The Governing Council** gives States voice but not a veto; its practical weight rises and falls with attendance and the political alignment between the Centre and the States, so cooperative federalism is realised episodically.

- □□ **Competitive federalism via indices** can improve outcomes where States value the ranking, but it can also incentivise data-management over real reform — the classic measurement-distortion risk.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

"Toothless think-tank" critique: □□ without fund power NITI cannot enforce reform; the fiscal levers sit with the Finance Commission and CSS, so its recommendations depend on political acceptance.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT, VARIATION AND IMPLEMENTATION CONSTRAINTS: RECALL MAP

5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

V

Dimension 1 "Toothless think-tank" critique: □□ without fund power NITI cannot enforce reform; the fiscal levers sit with the Finance Commission and CSS, so its r	**Dimension 2** Counter: □□ NITI was redefined, not weakened — as an evaluator and cooperative-federalism forum it does work the Planning Commission never did (SDG In
Dimension 3 Variation: □□ engagement varies — some States have boycotted Governing Council meetings over devolution grievances, so cooperative federalism is not u	**Dimension 4** Implementation constraints: □□ infrequent Council meetings, executive-dependent appointments, the absence of any binding instrument, and the unresolve

STATIC THEORY

- **Counter:** □□ NITI was **redefined**, not weakened — as an evaluator and cooperative-federalism forum it does work the Planning Commission never did (SDG Index, Aspirational Districts), and removing allocation from a planning body arguably rationalised fiscal federalism.

- **Variation:** □□ engagement varies — some States have **boycotted Governing Council meetings** over devolution grievances, so cooperative federalism is not uniform.

- **Implementation constraints:** □□ infrequent Council meetings, executive-dependent appointments, the absence of any binding instrument, and the unresolved question of who does **long-horizon strategic planning** all limit NITI's reach.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Principles verdict: "NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission share a legal status but not a philosophy — the Commission commanded and allocated, NITI advises and coordinates — so the difference is of principle, from imperative planning to indicative, cooperative-and-competitive federalism."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.10 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Principles verdict: "NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission share a legal status but not a philosophy — the Commission commanded and allocated, NITI a	**Dimension 2** Federalism verdict: "NITI institutionalised cooperative federalism in the Governing Council and pioneered competitive federalism through indices, but
Dimension 3 Leverage verdict: "Judged as a think-tank and evaluator NITI succeeds; judged as a planner with the Commission's clout it cannot, because the fund pow	

STATIC THEORY

- **Federalism verdict:** "NITI institutionalised cooperative federalism in the Governing Council and pioneered competitive federalism through indices, but with no fiscal leverage its influence is persuasive, not directive."

- **Leverage verdict:** "Judged as a think-tank and evaluator NITI succeeds; judged as a planner with the Commission's clout it cannot, because the fund power it would need now rests with the Finance Ministry."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2019 AIM objective demand) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
NITI constitutional/statutory	**Neither** — created by a **Union Cabinet resolution (1 Jan 2015)**
Planning Commission's legal status	**Also non-statutory** — a **1950 Cabinet resolution**, not a constitutional body
Who chairs NITI	The **Prime Minister** (not the President)
Fund allocation	NITI has **no power to allocate funds** — that is with the **Finance Ministry**
Governing Council	**All State CMs + CMs of UTs with legislatures + LGs of other UTs**
Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)	An **initiative housed within NITI Aayog** (Atal Tinkering Labs, Atal Incubation Centres) — **not** a separate statutory body
Five-Year Plans	**Ended** with the **12th Plan (2012–17)**; NITI issues Action Agenda/Strategy/Vision
NDC vs Governing Council	The **NDC's** plan-approval role **lapsed**; the **Governing Council** is NITI's apex forum

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2019 AIM objective demand)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2019 AIM objective demand) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Fiscal weight today	Carried by **Finance Commission (Art 280) transfers and CSS**, not by NITI
Vice-Chairperson	**Appointed by the PM** (Cabinet-Minister rank) — not elected
Four functions	Policy design · **cooperative federalism** · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank/knowledge hub
Planning horizon documents	**3-year Action Agenda · 7-year Strategy · 15-year Vision** (indicative, not imperative)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2019 AIM objective demand)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission are **both non-constitutional and non-statutory** (Cabinet resolutions of **2015** and **1950**) — do not call either constitutional/statutory. NITI has **no fund-allocation power**; it is **recommendatory**. The fund role moved to the **Finance Ministry** — state the direction of the change correctly. **Five-Year Plans ended with the 12th Plan (2012–17)**; NITI issues a **3-year Action Agenda, 7-year Strategy and 15-year Vision** — do not say NITI makes Five-Year Plans.

INTRO & ORIGIN

 The **Atal Innovation Mission is an initiative within NITI Aayog**, not an autonomous/statutory body — the exact routed 2019 point.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 The Atal Innovation Mission is an initiative within NITI Aayog, not an autonomous/statutory body — the exact routed 2019 point.	**Dimension 2** Boundary with the Economy folder: cite Finance Commission (Art 280) and CSS only to make the institutional-design/leverage point here; the devoluti
Dimension 3 Do not fabricate index scores, ranking tables, Governing-Council meeting counts or a list of boycotting States; name the instrument and flag figure	**Dimension 4** The National Development Council has not been formally abolished but its plan-approval role has lapsed — say "effectively lapsed," not "abolished."

STATIC THEORY

- **Boundary with the Economy folder:** cite Finance Commission (Art 280) and CSS only to make the **institutional-design/leverage** point here; the devolution and scheme-financing mechanics are owned there — do not duplicate or contradict.

- Do not fabricate index scores, ranking tables, Governing-Council meeting counts or a list of boycotting States; name the instrument and flag figures/status as variable.

- The **National Development Council** has **not been formally abolished** but its plan-approval role has lapsed — say "effectively lapsed," not "abolished."

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The **Atal Innovation Mission is an initiative within NITI Aayog**, not an autonomous/statutory body — the exact routed 2019 point.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	19	Atal Innovation Mission institutional setup arrangement	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.* ***Years represented:*** *2019* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Atal Innovation Mission institutional setup arrangement

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Atal Innovation Mission institutional setup arrangement	**Dimension 2** The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→	

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Legal status: *NITI Aayog was created by the Union Cabinet resolution of 1 January 2015. It is executive, non-constitutional and non-statutory; its advice becomes operative only through a competent legal or executive authority.* ***Institutional composition:*** *the Prime Minister is Chairperson. The design includes a Vice Chairperson, full-time members, up to two part-time members, up to four ex-officio Union Ministers, special invitees, a CEO and a Governing Council of State Chief Ministers, Chief Ministers of UTs with legislatures and Lieutenant Governors/Administrators of other UTs.* ***Latest formal composition control:*** *Cabinet Secretariat Notification No. 511/1/1/2024-Cab. dated 24 April 2026 appoints Ashok Kumar Lahiri as Vice Chairperson and Rajiv Gauba, Prof. K. V. Raju, Prof. Gobardhan Das, Prof. Abhay Karandikar and Dr M. Srinivas as full-time members, from assumption of charge until further orders. It retains the ex-officio members and special invitees in the 16 July 2024 notification.* ***Retained ex-officio members:*** *Raj Nath Singh, Amit Shah, Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Nirmala Sitharaman. The retained special invitees are Nitin Gadkari, J. P. Nadda, H. D. Kumaraswamy, Jitan Ram Manjhi, Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Virendra Kumar, K. Rammohan Naidu, Jual Oram, Annpurna Devi, Chirag Paswan and Rao Inderjit Singh, by the dated notifications.* ***Administrative roster:*** *the official 18 June 2026 directory identifies Nidhi Chhibber as CEO with additional charge. A directory entry is an operational snapshot, not a fixed constitutional or statutory tenure.* ***Functions:*** *foster cooperative federalism, formulate strategic policy, provide knowledge and technical support, monitor/evaluate programmes and use evidence, indices and initiatives to encourage learning and competition.* ***Limits:*** *NITI cannot legislate, tax, allocate the divisible pool, issue a Finance Commission award, bind States, or directly implement every programme. Rankings show measured performance; they do not by themselves prove causation.* ***Institution firewall:*** *Article 280 Finance Commission transfers, Article 279A GST Council recommendations, Article 263 coordination and statutory Zonal Councils retain distinct sources and powers.* ***PYQ firewall:*** *the direct 2018 Planning-Commission comparison and routed 2019 Atal Innovation Mission demand remain attached to this owner with notification-sensitive current composition.*

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II / GS-III

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II / GS-III	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 54 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = current affairs.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/NITI-Aayog.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 54 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = current affairs.

- *Companion: basic/NITI-Aayog.md.*

- □□ **Note:** NITI Aayog is **neither a constitutional nor a statutory body** — it was created by an **executive

- resolution** of the Union Cabinet (like the erstwhile Planning Commission).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ The 65-year-old **Planning Commission** was scrapped on **13 Aug 2014**; **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)** was established on **1 January 2015** as its successor — by an **executive resolution** (so **non-constitutional & non-statutory / extra-constitutional**).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □: RECALL MAP

PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

V

Dimension 1 □ The 65-year-old Planning Commission was scrapped on 13 Aug 2014; NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was established on 1 Janua	**Dimension 2** □ India's premier policy "Think Tank" — provides directional & policy inputs; a "Bharatiya approach to
Dimension 3 development."	**Dimension 4** □ Replaces the Planning Commission's one-way, top-down, command-and-control flow with a bottom-up,

STATIC THEORY

- □ India's **premier policy "Think Tank"** — provides directional & policy inputs; a **"Bharatiya approach to

- development."**

- □ Replaces the Planning Commission's **one-way, top-down, command-and-control** flow with a **bottom-up,

- collaborative **partnership of states —** cooperative federalism**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The 65-year-old **Planning Commission** was scrapped on **13 Aug 2014**; **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)** was established on **1 January 2015** as its successor — by an **executive resolution** (so **non-constitutional & non-statutory / extra-constitutional**).

2. India's **premier policy "Think Tank"** — provides directional & policy inputs; a **"Bharatiya approach to

3. Replaces the Planning Commission's **one-way, top-down, command-and-control** flow with a **bottom-up,

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — COMPOSITION □ · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ **Chairperson**	The **Prime Minister**
□ **Governing Council**	**CMs of all states** + CMs of UTs with legislatures (Delhi, Puducherry, J&K;) + **LGs of other UTs**
□ **Regional Councils**	For issues spanning multiple states/regions; formed for a fixed tenure; convened by the PM
□ **Vice-Chairperson**	Appointed by the PM; **rank of Cabinet Minister**
□ **Full-time Members**	Rank of **Minister of State**
□ **Part-time Members**	Max **2** (from universities/research bodies, rotational)
□ **Ex-officio Members**	Max **4** Union ministers (nominated by the PM)
□ **CEO**	Appointed by the **PM** for a fixed tenure; **rank of Secretary to the GoI**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — COMPOSITION □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — COMPOSITION □ · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ **Special Invitees**	Domain experts nominated by the PM

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — COMPOSITION □

HIGH

Advanced · Specialised wings □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Research Wing (in-house think tank) · **Consultancy Wing** (match-making with private/public expertise) · **Team India Wing** (representatives of every state & ministry — the liaison for cooperative federalism).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Specialised wings □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Four core functions:** (1) **Design policy & programme framework**; (2) **Foster cooperative federalism**; (3) **Monitoring & evaluation**; (4) **Think-tank / Knowledge & Innovation Hub**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □: RECALL MAP

PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

V

Dimension 1 □ Four core functions: (1) Design policy & programme framework; (2) Foster cooperative federalism; (3) Monitoring & evaluation; (4) Think-tank / Knowl	**Dimension 2** □ Two hubs: Team India Hub (cooperative federalism + policy design) & Knowledge & Innovation Hub
Dimension 3 (resource centre / best practices).	**Dimension 4** □□ Key limitation: NITI Aayog only recommends — it has NO power to allocate funds (budgetary allocation belongs to competent governments and fiscal in

STATIC THEORY

- □ Two hubs: **Team India Hub** (cooperative federalism + policy design) & **Knowledge & Innovation Hub**

- (resource centre / best practices).

- □□ **Key limitation:** NITI Aayog **only recommends** — it has **NO power to allocate funds** (budgetary allocation belongs to competent governments and fiscal institutions). It cannot impose plans on states.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Four core functions: (1) **Design policy & programme framework**; (2) **Foster cooperative federalism**; (3) **Monitoring & evaluation**; (4) **Think-tank / Knowledge & Innovation Hub**.

2. Two hubs: **Team India Hub** (cooperative federalism + policy design) & **Knowledge & Innovation Hub**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Planning Commission (1950–2014)	NITI Aayog (2015–)
□ Basis	Executive resolution	Executive resolution
□ Role	Allocated **funds/grants** to states	**Advisory think tank** — no fund allocation
□ Federal approach	**Top-down** (command)	**Bottom-up** (cooperative)
□ Plans	Five-Year Plans (imposed)	Strategy/vision docs, no imposition
□□ States' role	Passive recipients	Participants through the Governing Council
□□ Members	Full-time economists	PM-led + CMs + experts

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Note:** Five-Year Plans ended with the **12th Plan (2012–17)**; NITI Aayog issued a **3-year Action Agenda**, a **7-year Strategy** and a **15-year Vision** document instead.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Ministry**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: NITI Aayog is a constitutional/statutory body

CORRECT: it is **neither** (executive resolution).

WRONG: NITI Aayog allocates funds to states

CORRECT: it is **advisory only**; fund allocation is with the **Finance

WRONG: The President is the chairperson

CORRECT: the **Prime Minister**.

WRONG: Governing Council excludes UT chiefs

CORRECT: includes **CMs of UTs with legislatures + LGs of other UTs**.

WRONG: NITI Aayog still makes Five-Year Plans

CORRECT: those **ended** (12th Plan 2012–17); it makes vision/strategy docs.

WRONG: The Vice-Chairperson has Cabinet Minister rank but is elected

CORRECT: appointed by the PM.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ **SDG India Index**, **Aspirational Districts / Aspirational Blocks Programme**, **Multidimensional Poverty Index** — NITI's flagship monitoring tools. □ □□ Criticism that NITI Aayog is a **toothless think tank** without the Planning Commission's fund clout — the

INTRO & ORIGIN

cooperative-vs-coercive federalism debate (states boycotting Governing Council meetings).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ □□ **NITI Aayog @ development finance / green transition / AI strategy** reports shaping policy.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"NITI Aayog replaced allocation with advice — has it strengthened or weakened planning?" Examine. Cooperative federalism in practice: is NITI Aayog living up to its founding promise? The vacuum in India's planning architecture after the Planning Commission — assess. less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	11	NITI Aayog principles versus erstwhile Planning Commission differences	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE
Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2018* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-III* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

NITI Aayog principles versus erstwhile Planning Commission differences

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 NITI Aayog principles versus erstwhile Planning Commission differences	**Dimension 2** The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→	

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI